

North Carolina Mental Health & Substance Use Services Workforce Data 2024 Snapshot:

MENTAL HEALTH & SUBSTANCE USE SERVICES PHYSICIAN ASSISTANTS

3,605

MH/SU Prescribers

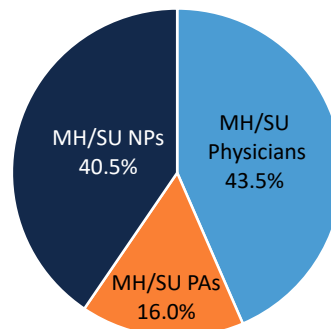
Active Practice, Mental Health & Substance Use
Services Prescribers

576

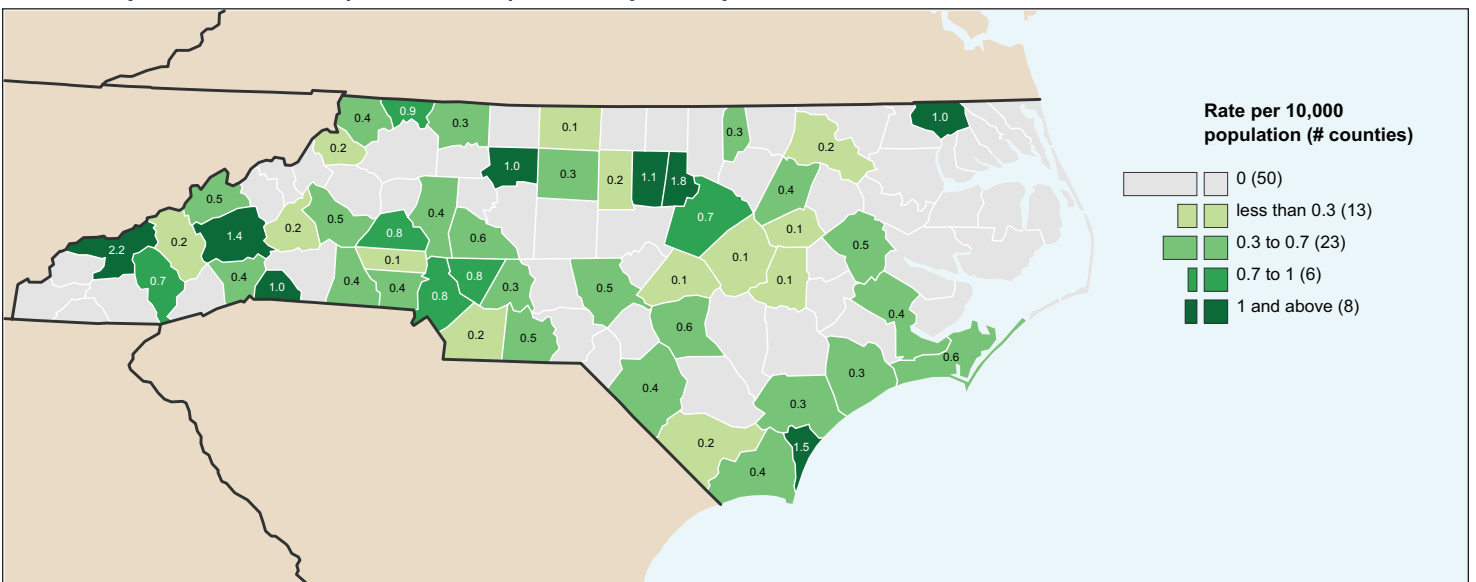
MH/SU PAs

Mental Health & Substance Use Services Physician
Assistants

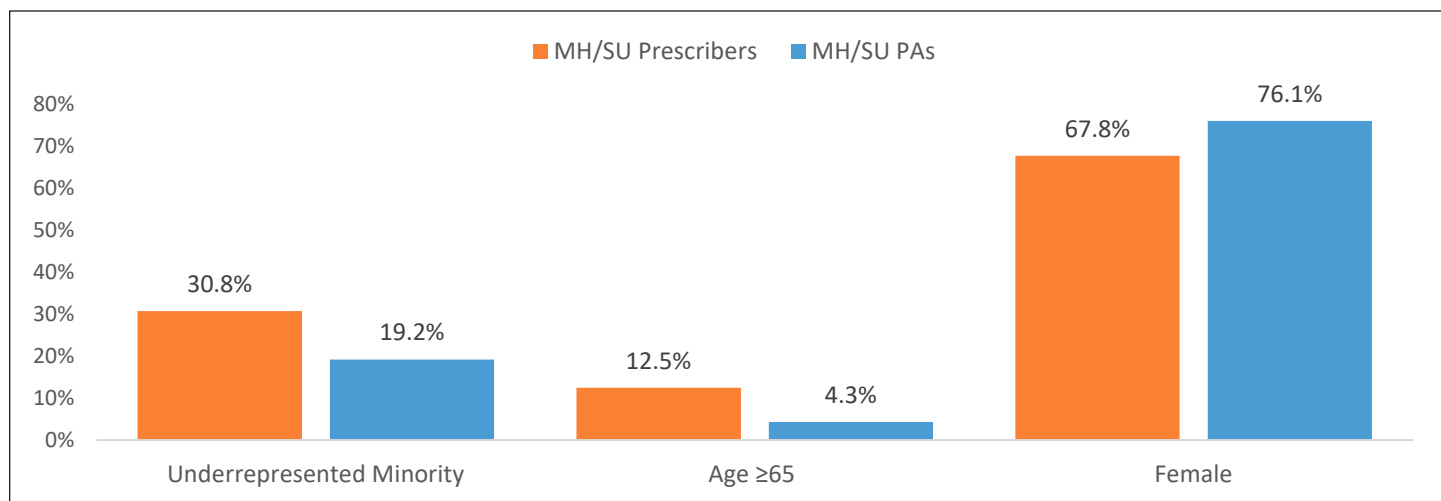
- The average rate for MH/SU PAs in-state was **0.52 per 10,000** population.
- MH/SU PA supply is **increasing**, up from 0.11 per 10,000 population in 2014.
- MH/SU PA comprised **16.0% of the total MH/SU prescriber workforce** in North Carolina in 2024.



MH/SU Physician Assistants per 10,000 Population by County, North Carolina, 2024



Demographics of MH/SU Prescribers vs MH/SU PAs, 2024

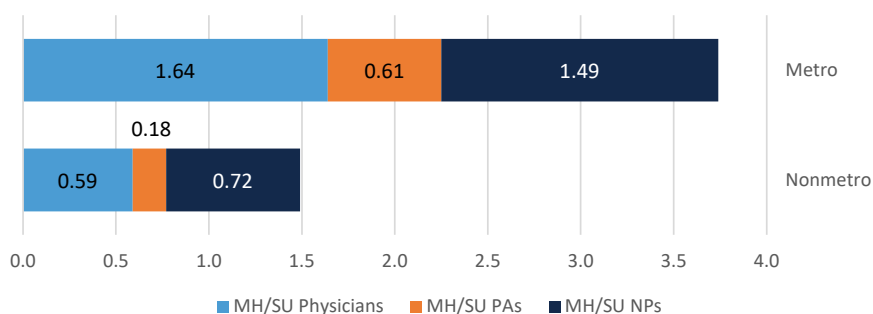


Demographics, 2024

MH/SU Physician Assistants:

- **76.1%** female
- **4.3%** ≥ 65 years
- **19.2%** underrepresented minority

Metro and Nonmetro County Rate per 10k by Licensure Type, 2024



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The state average was **0.52 MH/SU PAs per 10,000 population**, distributed unevenly throughout the state. Half of North Carolina's counties (**50 counties**) had **no MH/SU PAs**. More than **80% of counties** were lower than the state average while seven counties had twice the state average.
- **Metro counties had more than three times the rate of MH/SU PAs** vs nonmetro counties: 0.61 vs 0.18 per 10,000 population.
- MH/SU PAs in NC increased from 2014-2024 and comprised **16.0% of MH/SU prescribers** in the state in 2024. Most MH/SU PAs (90%) specialized in general psychiatry, while 9% specialized in addiction medicine and 1% in child & adolescent psychiatry.

For more information, please find the full report at: <https://nchealthworkforce.unc.edu/projects/mhsu-workforce/>



NC DEPARTMENT OF
**HEALTH AND
HUMAN SERVICES**
Division of Mental Health,
Developmental Disabilities and
Substance Use Services

**SHEPS HEALTH
WORKFORCE NC**

This project was supported by the NC Department of Health and Human Services, Division of Mental Health, Developmental Disabilities and Substance Use Services (DMHDDSUS). The information, content and conclusions are those of the authors and should not be construed as the official position or policy of, nor should any endorsements be inferred by DMHDDSUS.

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